

Japanese Language Society

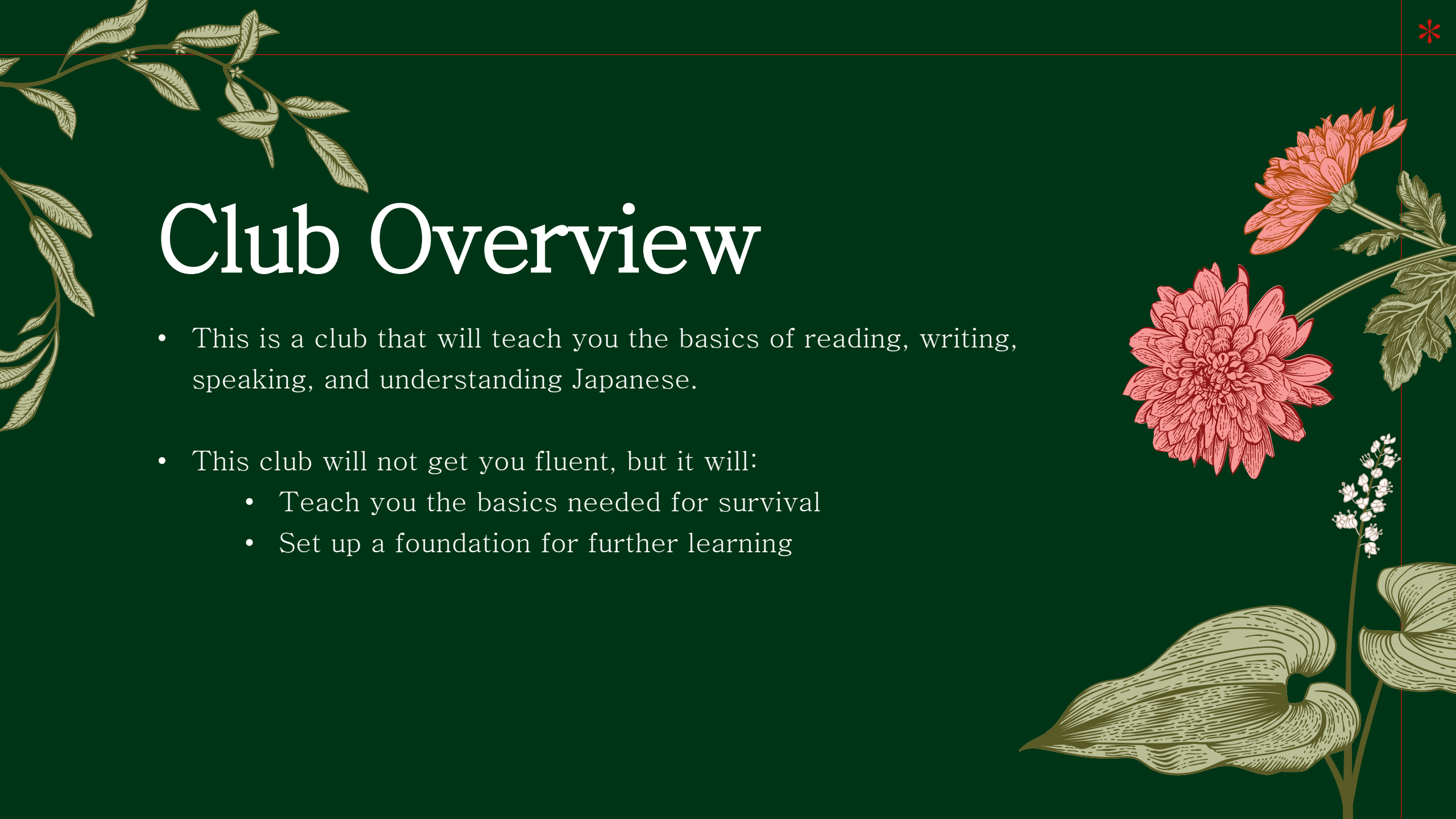


First Meeting | 初対面

Agenda

- Introductions
- Club overview
- The basics
 - Pronunciation
 - Writing system
 - Grammar
- Your first sentence!
- Useful resources





Club Overview

- This is a club that will teach you the basics of reading, writing, speaking, and understanding Japanese.
- This club will not get you fluent, but it will:
 - Teach you the basics needed for survival
 - Set up a foundation for further learning



PART I: Pronunciation

発音

Pronunciation



Manner of Articulation	Bilabial	Labio-dental	Dental	Alveolar	Post-alveolar & Alveolo-palatal	Palatal	Velar & Labio-velar	Uvular	Glottal
Plosive (Stop)	p, b			t, d			k, g		
Nasal	m			n		ɲ	ŋ	ɴ	
Tap / Flap				ɾ / ɽ					
Fricative	ɸ / ɸ̥	f, v	θ, ð	s, z	ʃ, ʒ (EN) ɕ, ʐ (JP)	ç			h
Affricate				ts, dz / っ づ	tʃ, dʒ (EN) tɕ, dʑ (JP)				
Approximant				ɹ		j	w (EN) ɰ (JP)		
Lateral Approximant				l					

Exists in English and Japanese

Only exists in English

Only exists in Japanese

Minor pronunciation differences

Long Vowels & Voiced/Unvoiced Consonants

- Japanese pronunciation is based around “mora”, or beats. Each character is a single mora.
- Two vowels next to each other in Japanese indicates that it will stretch for two, or even three mora!!
- Two words might sound similar but have completely different meanings because of a single long vowel!
- For example:
 - 主人 – Means husband, pronounced **shujin**, with one mora for the “u”
 - 囚人 – Means prisoner, pronounced **shuujin**, with two mora for the “u”.
- Japanese also makes a distinction between two types of consonants:
 - **Voiced**: your vocal cords vibrate, but you do not expel air out of your mouth. (m, g, v, z)
 - **Unvoiced**: your vocal cords do not vibrate, but air is expelled out of your lungs. (s, k, t, h)
- This is important, as some vowels are devoiced if a syllable **follows a voiced consonant** or is **squished between two unvoiced consonants**.
 - Ex: です is pronounced **des**, instead of **desu**.
 - Ex: がすき is pronounced **ga ski**, instead of **ga suki**



PART II: Hiragana

平仮名

Hiragana



n	w-	r-	y-	m-	h-	n-	t-	s-	k-		
ん N	わ WA	ら RA	や YA	ま MA	は HA	な NA	た TA	さ SA	か KA	あ A	-a
	ゐ WI	り RI		み MI	ひ HI	に NI	ち CHI	し SHI	き KI	い I	-i
		る RU	ゆ YU	む MU	ふ FU	ぬ NU	つ TSU	す SU	く KU	う U	-u
	ゑ WE	れ RE		め ME	へ HE	ね NE	て TE	せ SE	け KE	え E	-e
	を WO	ろ RO	よ YO	も MO	ほ HO	の NO	と TO	そ SO	こ KO	お O	-o

Hiragana



- Hiragana is a syllabary, where each character represents a syllable, rather than a single sound (with some exceptions).
- These symbols are used for native Japanese words, grammar, and verb endings.
- These symbols come from simplified Chinese characters, which were originally used to write the entirety of Japanese.
- Spelling is incredibly easy with hiragana. Except for a few minor exceptions, all words are written as pronounced and vice versa!
- Remember hiragana with mnemonics:
 - も (mo)
 - It looks like a fishhook with worms on it, so that you can catch MOre fish.

HIRAGANA CHART

	a	i	u	e	o
	a あ	i い	u う	e え	o お
K	ka か	ki き	ku く	ke け	ko こ
S	sa さ	shi し	su す	se せ	so そ
T	ta た	chi ち	tsu つ	te て	to と
N	na な	ni に	nu ぬ	ne ね	no の
H	ha は	hi ひ	fu ふ	he へ	ho ほ
M	ma ま	mi み	mu む	me め	mo も
Y	ya や		yu ゆ		yo よ
R	ra ら	ri り	ru る	re れ	ro ろ
W	wa わ		n ん		wo を
G	ga が	gi ぎ	gu ぐ	ge げ	go ご
Z	za ざ	ji じ	zu ず	ze ぜ	zo ぞ
D	da だ	di ぢ	du づ	de で	do ど
B	ba ば	bi び	bu ぶ	be べ	bo ぼ
P	pa ぱ	pi ぴ	pu ぷ	pe ぺ	po ぽ

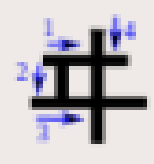
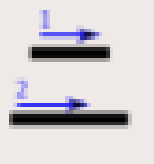
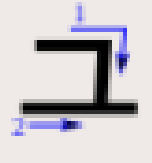
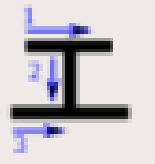
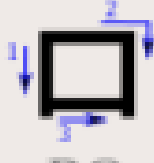
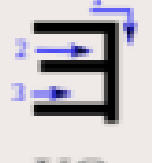
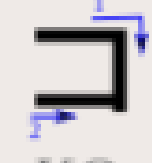


PART II: Katakana

カタカナ

Katakana



n	w-	r-	y-	m-	h-	n-	t-	s-	k-		
 N	 WA	 RA	 YA	 MA	 HA	 NA	 TA	 SA	 KA	 A	-a
	 WI	 RI		 MI	 HI	 NI	 CHI	 SHI	 KI	 I	-i
		 RU	 YU	 MU	 FU	 NU	 TSU	 SU	 KU	 U	-u
	 WE	 RE		 ME	 HE	 NE	 TE	 SE	 KE	 E	-e
	 WO	 RO	 YO	 MO	 HO	 NO	 TO	 SO	 KO	 O	-o

Katakana



- Katakana represents all the same syllables as hiragana.
- These symbols are used for loanwords, onomatopoeia, and stylization.
- These symbols also come from simplified Chinese characters.

- Remember katakana with mnemonics:
 - ル (ru)
 - It looks like a two roads, or ROUtes.

KATAKANA CHART

	a	i	u	e	o
	ア ^a	イ ⁱ	ウ ^u	エ ^e	オ ^o
K	カ ^{ka}	キ ^{ki}	ク ^{ku}	ケ ^{ke}	コ ^{ko}
S	サ ^{sa}	シ ^{shi}	ス ^{su}	セ ^{se}	ソ ^{so}
T	タ ^{ta}	チ ^{chi}	ツ ^{tsu}	テ ^{te}	ト ^{to}
N	ナ ^{na}	ニ ⁿⁱ	ヌ ^{nu}	ネ ^{ne}	ノ ^{no}
H	ハ ^{ha}	ヒ ^{hi}	フ ^{fu}	ヘ ^{he}	ホ ^{ho}
M	マ ^{ma}	ミ ^{mi}	ム ^{mu}	メ ^{me}	モ ^{mo}
Y	ヤ ^{ya}		ユ ^{yu}		ヨ ^{yo}
R	ラ ^{ra}	リ ^{ri}	ル ^{ru}	レ ^{re}	ロ ^{ro}
W	ワ ^{wa}		ン ⁿ		ヲ ^{wo}
G	ガ ^{ga}	ギ ^{gi}	グ ^{gu}	ゲ ^{ge}	ゴ ^{go}
Z	ザ ^{za}	ジ ^{ji}	ズ ^{zu}	ゼ ^{ze}	ゾ ^{zo}
D	ダ ^{da}	ヂ ^{di}	ヅ ^{du}	デ ^{de}	ド ^{do}
B	バ ^{ba}	ビ ^{bi}	ブ ^{bu}	ベ ^{be}	ボ ^{bo}
P	パ ^{pa}	ピ ^{pi}	プ ^{pu}	ペ ^{pe}	ポ ^{po}

- Kana with dakuten make a voiced/“hard” sound. It forces you to vibrate your vocal cords.
- Ex:
 - か VS が
 - て VS で
 - ち VS ぢ & つ VS づ
 - は VS ば
- Kana with handakuten make a p sound.
- Ex:
 - は VS ぱ
 - ひ VS ぴ

Dakuten & Handakuten

*

が ga	ぎ gi	ぐ gu	げ ge	ご go
ざ za	じ zi	ず zu	ぜ ze	ぞ zo
だ da	ぢ di	ど do	で de	ど do
ば ba	び bi	ぶ bu	べ be	ぼ bo
ぱ pa	ぴ pi	ぷ pu	ぺ pe	ぽ po

kanaquest.com

Combination Sounds

- Hiragana and katakana characters that represent syllables ending with “i” can be combined with small kana for ya, yu, yo to make new sounds.
- Ex:
 - き and small ャ makes きゃ while
き and big ュ makes きゅ
- Remember, this works for BOTH hiragana and katakana, just interchange the characters.

Hiragana Combination Chart

	や ya	ゆ yu	よ yo
き ki	きゃ kya	きゅ kyu	きょ kyo
ぎ gi	ぎゃ gya	ぎゅ gyu	ぎょ gyo
し shi	しゃ sha	しゅ shu	しょ sho
じ ji	じゃ ja	じゅ ju	じょ jo
ち chi	ちゃ cha	ちゅ chu	ちょ cho
ぢ ji	ぢゃ ja	ぢゅ ju	ぢょ jo

	や ya	ゆ yu	よ yo
に ni	にゃ nya	にゅ nyu	にょ nyo
ひ hi	ひゃ hya	ひゅ hyu	ひょ hyo
び bi	びゃ bya	びゅ byu	びょ byo
ぴ pi	ぴゃ pya	ぴゅ pyu	ぴょ pyo
み mi	みゃ mya	みゅ myu	みょ myo
り ri	りゃ rya	りゅ ryu	りょ ryo



PART III: Kanji

漢字

- Kanji are the Chinese characters borrowed to be used for Japanese. This is the largest and most complex writing system in Japanese.
- Each Kanji can have multiple different readings and be used in multiple words.
- A small number of basic Kanji are pictographic, where they look like the thing they represent.
 - Ex: 火, which means “fire”.

- You shouldn't try to memorize kanji and their readings by themselves. Instead, focus on learning whole words.

日本	東京	大阪	北海道			
Japan	Tokyo	Osaka	Hokkaido			
山	川	日	雨	水	火	田
mountain	river	sun	rain	water	fire	rice field
米	魚	寿司	肉	酒	茶	
rice	fish	sushi	meat	alcohol	tea	
車	電気	自転車	飛行機			
car	electricity	bicycle	airplane			
一	二	三	四	五	六	七
one	two	three	four	five	six	seven
男	女	松井秀喜	黒沢明			
man	woman	Matsui Hideki	Kurozawa Akira			
食べる	行く	小	大	多	少	
to eat	to go	small	big	many	few	



PART IV: Grammar

文法

Subject	Verb	Object
Akos	eats	apples.
Subject	Object	Verb
Akos アコシは	apples リンゴを	eats. 食べます

- Japanese grammar is based on many “particles” that are attached to nouns, verbs, and whole phrases.
- Japanese lacks **articles** (a, an, the), **grammatical gender**, and **plurality** for nouns.
- The subject of the sentence can be dropped entirely and is often inferred from context.
- There are varying levels of politeness in Japanese, and they are directly tied into the grammar system.

Ex: 食べる VS 食べます



PART V: First Sentence

最初の文

Your First Sentence!!!

A は B です。

Topic

Topic
marker

Object

Verb



PART VI: Useful Resources

便利なツール





Useful Tools

- The following are some amazing Japanese learning resources:
 - **Jisho:** Comprehensive Japanese dictionary, with example sentences and reading aid.
 - **10ten Reader:** Browser extension with Jisho built-in for Japanese reading help.
 - **Tofugu:** Many well written Japanese guides including hiragana & katakana.
 - **Bunpro:** Excellent grammar guides organized by JLPT difficulty level.
 - **Anki:** Spaced repetition software for flash cards. There are many card decks available online for Japanese learning.
- These resources are great for Japanese immersion:
 - **NHK Easy News:** Simple news articles with furigana (reading aids).
 - **YouTube:** Many YouTubers make beginner friendly listening videos and tutorials.
 - **Japanese Media:** Anime, Manga, Books, Video Games.

Thank you!

ありがとうございます

